

Thrust Vectoring (TVR) Hardware Budget Estimate

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1. Summary

This year's TVR avionics is a custom multi-board stack. This proposal splits the ask into **needs** (required to build and fly this year) and **wants** (boards that add real value but the vehicle can fly without). Two totals are given so the funding can be scaled: a **minimum (1004 CAD)** and a **full build (1327 CAD)**.

Component costs are for **2 of each board** (spares for rework and respin). PCB fabrication is quoted for **5 boards** each (minimum order), sized from JLCPCB, excluding any JLC sponsorship or discounts, so the real cost may come in lower. The LiPo battery, motors, and propellers are already in hand and are not part of this ask.

Tier	Amount
Needs (boards + GNSS antenna + shipping)	625 CAD
General items (wires, soldering supplies, ST-Link)	379 CAD
Minimum (needs + general items)	1004 CAD
Wants (value-add boards + shipping)	323 CAD

Tier	Amount
Full build (everything)	1327 CAD

If the full build is funded, every board and embedded system in TVR is built in house. All the custom electronics, from the flight controller to the motor drive to the charger to the telemetry ground station, are our own design. The only off-the-shelf hardware is the physical components that are not practical to build ourselves, like the motors, battery, and Dynamixel servos.

2. Needs (required this year)

These are the core of the vehicle and its bring-up. Without them, TVR cannot fly.

Item	What it is for	Components (2 boards)	PCB (5 boards)	Total
FC PCB (8-layer)	Flight controller: runs the real-time control loop that keeps the vehicle stable, fuses IMU/ baro/GNSS/LiDAR data, drives the motors and gimbal.	278	123	401 CAD
Backplane PCB (4-layer)	Power distribution to the stack, battery voltage/current monitoring, cell monitoring and passive balancing, servo and camera rails.	47	10	57 CAD
GNSS Antenna (1x)	Feeds the RTK GNSS on the FC, for positioning and as a redundant height source. Required for the FC to function.			80 CAD
Test PCB (2-layer)	Breakout for the board-to-board connectors, used during bring-up to probe and validate the stack before full assembly. Needed to safely bring up the FC and backplane.	14	6	20 CAD
LiDAR PCB (2-layer)	Small carrier board for the LiDAR height sensor, mounted separately from the FC for placement. Provides precise low-altitude height for the control loop.	13	4	17 CAD

Item	What it is for	Components (2 boards)	PCB (5 boards)	Total
Shipping (needs orders)	Shipping for the needs-side PCB (JLCPCB) and component (LCSC) orders.			50 CAD
Needs subtotal				625 CAD

Note: the FC is costed at 8-layer fabrication (123 CAD) as a worst case. It may be achievable in 6 layers, which would drop the fab to ~43 CAD and save ~80 CAD. This is confirmed during layout.

3. General items (required for the build)

Not a single board, but required to build, assemble, and operate the stack. These supplies and tools are expected to last about 1 to 1.5 years (this project plus future builds), so they are largely a one-time cost rather than recurring.

Item	What it is for	Cost
Basic items (JST connectors, wire, Kapton tape, heat shrink)	Interconnects, wiring harnesses, insulation, and assembly consumables.	116 CAD
Soldering supplies	Solder, solder paste, flux (thin + tack), tweezers, hot-air nozzles for fine-pitch reflow assembly.	187 CAD
ST-Link debuggers (2x)	Program and debug the FC and ESC MCUs over SWD during bring-up.	76 CAD
General items subtotal		379 CAD

Detailed product links (general items):

Item	Link	Qty	Cost
Solder	Solder (Amazon)	3	45.00 CAD
Thin Flux	Thin Flux (AliExpress)	1	40.99 CAD

Item	Link	Qty	Cost
Tack Flux	Tack Flux (AliExpress)	1	15.28 CAD
Solder Paste	Solder Paste (AliExpress)	5	39.95 CAD
Titanium Tweezers	Titanium Tweezers (AliExpress)	2	19.72 CAD
Ceramic Tweezers	Ceramic Tweezers (AliExpress)	1	15.28 CAD
Hot Air Nozzles	Nozzles (AliExpress)	1	10.38 CAD
ST-Link (2x)	ST-Link (Digikey)	2	76.42 CAD
JST Connectors 2.54mm	JST 2.54mm (Amazon)	1	20.00 CAD
JST Connectors 1mm	JST 1mm (Amazon)	1	25.00 CAD
Wire	Silicone Wire (Amazon)	1	22.88 CAD
Kapton Tape	Kapton Tape (Amazon)	1	24.29 CAD
Heat Shrink	Heat Shrink (Amazon)	1	24.29 CAD
		Total	379.48 CAD

These general supplies (solder, paste, flux, wire, tape, connectors, tweezers, debuggers) are consumables and tools expected to last roughly 1 to 1.5 years, covering this project and future builds, not a per-board recurring cost.

4. Wants (Adds real value, but the vehicle can fly without them)

Each adds capability; the charger in particular has value beyond TVR, COTS is interested in them to put them inside the rocket as well. Ranked roughly by value.

Board	What it is for	Components (2 boards)	PCB (5 boards)	Total
ESC PCB (6-layer)	Custom dual-channel motor controller. Strong want and a major capability/learning piece, but a commercial ESC can fly the vehicle in the meantime.	138	43	181 CAD

Board	What it is for	Components (2 boards)	PCB (5 boards)	Total
USB-C PD Charger (DFT) (4-layer)	100W USB-C PD bench charger for the LiPo, to charge packs in the field without a separate charger. Shared value: the COTS Rocket hardware lead wants it for their stack too, so one board serves both teams.	78	10	88 CAD
Custom Telemetry GND Station (4-layer)	Ground-side board for the 915 MHz telemetry link, a matched ground station for our custom radio.	19	10	29 CAD
Shipping (wants orders)	Shipping for the wants-side PCB (JLCPCB) and component (LCSC) orders.			25 CAD
Wants subtotal				323 CAD

For now, these functions are covered by off-the-shelf options: a commercial ESC drives the motors, a bought charger charges the packs, and off-the-shelf ground hardware handles telemetry. The vehicle can fly and operate this way.

Funding the wants replaces those off-the-shelf options with our own designs, making the entire TVR hardware system in house. The custom ESC replaces the commercial ESC, our charger replaces the bought charger, and the telemetry ground station replaces the off-the-shelf ground hardware. With the full build, no part of the hardware is a commercial off-the-shelf unit, it is all our own design.

5. Component breakdown per board

Component quantities and costs are for **2 boards** except where noted. Small passives are consolidated into one line per board; explicit key parts (shunt, connectors, ICs, etc.) are listed separately. A USB-C connector is included on each board at 0.40 CAD. All parts from LCSC.

5.1 FC PCB

Component	Qty	Cost (CAD)
ZED-F9P RTK GNSS	2	170.00
IMU (@4.60)	10	46.00
Baro (@3.50)	6	21.00
Passives (decoupling, RF matching, protection, crystals, LEDs, test points)	2 sets	26.40
SX1262 915 MHz radio	2	6.40
Board-to-board mezzanine (@1.25)	4	5.00
UWB interface connectors	4	2.00
USB-C connector	2	0.80
STM32H745 MCU	2	0.00 (owned)
Component total (2 boards)		277.60
PCB fabrication (5 boards, 8-layer)		123.00
FC board total		401 CAD

Note: IMU and baro are a shared purchase (10 IMU, 6 baro total): each TVR FC board carries 3 IMU and 1 baro, so 6 IMU and 2 baro across the 2 TVR boards, plus 1 IMU and 1 baro as TVR spares; the remaining 3 IMU and 3 baro cover the COTS board. MCU reused from the previous FC, so not purchased. The LiDAR is on its own carrier board (see LiDAR PCB).

5.2 ESC PCB

Component	Qty	Cost (CAD)
FET IAUC120N04S6L005	24	55.20
Passives (polymer/tantalum bulk, ceramics, gate resistors, bootstrap, LEDs)	2 sets	34.00
Gate driver DRV8353S	4	17.60
MCU STM32G070CBT6	4	7.60

Component	Qty	Cost (CAD)
Fuel gauge BQ34Z100	2	5.20
Motor bullet connectors	12	5.00
Board-to-board mezzanine (@1.25)	4	5.00
ST-Link/debug header	2	4.00
Battery + balance connectors	2 sets	2.60
Current-sense shunt (Kelvin)	2	0.98
USB-C connector	2	0.80
Component total (2 boards)		137.98
PCB fabrication (5 boards, 6-layer)		43.00
ESC board total		181 CAD

5.3 Backplane PCB

Component	Qty	Cost (CAD)
Passives (bulk, decoupling, protection TVS, balance bleed resistors, LEDs, test points, camera power)	2 sets	13.80
Rail regulation (5V buck, 12V Dynamixel buck, 3V3 LDO)	2 sets	9.00
Power/load-switch FETs (@0.70)	12	8.40
Cell monitor + passive balance (BQ76942)	2	5.34
Board-to-board mezzanine (@1.25)	4	5.00
Other connectors (balance, power, camera, servo out)	2 sets	5.00
USB-C connector	2	0.80
Component total (2 boards)		47.34

Component	Qty	Cost (CAD)
PCB fabrication (5 boards, 4-layer)		10.00
Backplane board total		57 CAD

5.4 USB-C PD Charger DFT PCB

Component	Qty	Cost (CAD)
Passives (bulk poly/tantalum/ceramic, PD protection TVS/ESD, test points, LEDs)	2 sets	24.90
Charger FETs (higher-voltage, for up to 10-14S range)	2 sets	12.00
BQ25756 bidirectional buck-boost charger	2	10.06
OLED display	2	8.00
TPS25751 PD controller	2	5.54
BQ76942 monitor	2	5.34
Small MCU (OLED/UI + digital charge V/I control)	2	4.00
Battery connectors (DC jack, XT60, JST, terminal blocks)	2 sets	3.08
Charger inductor(s)	2 sets	2.42
Charge voltage/current adjust (buttons)	2 sets	2.00
USB-C connector	2	0.80
Component total (2 boards)		78.14
PCB fabrication (5 boards, 4-layer)		10.00
Charger board total		88 CAD

5.5 Custom Telemetry GND Station PCB

Component	Qty	Cost (CAD)
Passives (RF matching, 3V3 LDO, decoupling, misc)	2 sets	6.60

Component	Qty	Cost (CAD)
SX1262 915 MHz radio	2	6.40
FTDI USB-UART bridge	2	5.00
USB-C connector	2	0.80
SMA connector	2	0.60
Component total (2 boards)		19.40
PCB fabrication (5 boards, 4-layer)		10.00
Telemetry GND board total		29 CAD

5.6 Test PCB

Component	Qty	Cost (CAD)
Passives (3V3 LDO, breakout headers, decoupling)	2 sets	5.20
Board-to-board mezzanine (@1.25)	4	5.00
5V buck	2	2.96
USB-C connector	2	0.80
Component total (2 boards)		13.96
PCB fabrication (5 boards, 2-layer)		6.00
Test board total		20 CAD

5.7 LiDAR PCB

Component	Qty	Cost (CAD)
LiDAR sensor (@5.70)	2	11.40
Connector to FC + decoupling passives	2 sets	1.50
Component total (2 boards)		12.90
PCB fabrication (5 boards, 2-layer)		4.00

Component	Qty	Cost (CAD)
LiDAR board total		17 CAD

5.8 Board cost totals

Board	Total
FC PCB	401 CAD
ESC PCB	181 CAD
USB-C PD Charger DFT	88 CAD
Backplane PCB	57 CAD
Custom Telemetry GND Station	29 CAD
Test PCB	20 CAD
LiDAR PCB	17 CAD
All boards total	793 CAD

5.9 Sourcing summary

Components are sourced from **LCSC**, PCB fabrication from **JLCPCB**. Totals are split across needs and wants (component quantities for 2 boards, PCB fab for 5 boards each).

Source	Needs	Wants	Total
Components (LCSC)	352 CAD	236 CAD	587 CAD
PCB fabrication (JLCPCB)	143 CAD	63 CAD	206 CAD
RTK-GNSS Antenna (separate)	80 CAD	---	80 CAD
Combined	575 CAD	299 CAD	873 CAD

The GNSS antenna is sourced separately from a dedicated supplier (not LCSC or JLCPCB).

Order links:

Item	Source
All components	LCSC
All PCBs	JLCPCB
RTK-GNSS Antenna	GNSS Antenna

6. What is not in this ask

- **LiPo battery, motors, propellers** already in hand.
- **STM32H745 MCU** reused from the previous flight controller.

7. The ask

- **Minimum: 1004 CAD** (FC + Backplane + Test PCB + LiDAR PCB + GNSS antenna + needs shipping + general items).
- **Full build: 1327 CAD** (adds the ESC, the shared-use USB-C PD charger, and the telemetry ground station).

A 25% margin of safety is added on the full build to cover price changes, stock substitutions, order-quantity minimums, and rework or respins.

Item	Amount
Full build	1327 CAD
Margin of safety (25%)	332 CAD
Total budget requested	1659 CAD

Funding the full build means the entire TVR hardware system is built in house, with no commercial off-the-shelf units anywhere. Every board and every hardware subsystem, from the motor drive to the charger to the ground station, is our own design. The charger is the strongest single want to fund even on a tight budget, since it is shared with the COTS Rocket team and pays back across two projects.

Component prices are LCSC estimates at the time; final cost depends on stock and order quantity. PCB fabrication quoted for 5 boards from JLCPCB, excluding sponsorship/discounts.